

Spain: Snap election likely to yield center-right government

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【メール原文】

Snap November elections are likely to yield center right majority. Sanchez announced he will trigger snap elections after parliament failed to pass a |||||

Spain

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Short-term trajectory:

Long-term trajectory:

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Prime Minister Pedro Sanchez called a snap election for 29 November after parliament rejected a housing decree the government had tabled after weeks of protests over housing, a tactical move to give the center-left its best shot at keeping power.

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Eurasia Group sees a 70% probability (down from 75%) that the center-right opposition will win a majority and lead the next government, given the conservatives' solid polling lead, Sanchez's weak approval ratings and the unfavorable environment for incumbents.

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The left still has a path to a majority: making housing the central issue could mobilize left-leaning voters and lead to some consolidation in the heavily fragmented left, while an earlier vote limits scope for a further erosion in support amid resurgent inflation, legislative deadlock, and ongoing corruption scandals.

Snap November elections are likely to yield center right majority. Sanchez announced he will trigger snap elections after parliament failed to pass a high-profile decree on housing policy. This is a tactical move designed to give the ruling center-left the best shot at retaining a majority.

The conservative opposition is well-placed to win, and is likely to secure a majority, given its solid polling lead, Saánchez's lackluster approval ratings, and the unfavorable environment for incumbents. Eurasia Group sees a 70% probability of the elections yielding a center-right majority, down from 75% (see Spain: Next year's elections likely to produce a right-wing government , 17 September 2026).

The left still has a path to victory. Sanchez has a long track record of turning around difficult elections. In both 2019 and 2023, he was widely expected to lose, having started well behind the conservative opposition in opinion polls. This reflects both his ability to successfully mobilize voters in the final stretch of the campaign, and a structural lean towards the right-wing party in opinion polls. The timing of the elections, a strategy based on leveraging housing policy, and the prospect of a somewhat less fragmented left will help give him a fighting chance.

Housing policy can become a rallying cry for the left. The housing bill, drawn up in response to a wave of protests over the last week, was rejected after conservative-leaning Catalan and Basque parties, formerly allied with the government, voted against. By choosing housing policy as the proximate trigger, the government hopes to shift responsibility for the worsening housing crunch on the right, and to mobilize left-leaning voters by signaling the prospect of more interventionist housing policies.

The accelerated timeline can also favor the incumbents. Elections had been scheduled to take place by August 2027 at the latest. Eurasia Group had expected the vote to be brought forward to the first or second quarter. Sanchez's decision to bring it forward by a few months will not fundamentally alter the picture. However, it can help stem a further erosion in support over the course of 2027, given the difficult environment for incumbents, characterized by resurgent inflation, continued legislative deadlock, and ongoing corruption scandals.

The left is likely to become somewhat less fragmented. In order to win a majority, the ruling socialist party will have to once again rely on a constellation of leftist and regional allies (no less than six in the current parliament). This fragmentation puts the left at a significant disadvantage, as the electoral system tends to benefit larger parties. However, pressure from the base around housing policy is giving new impetus to efforts to create a more united front, which will likely lead to some degree of consolidation. This could help make the electoral math less unfavorable for the left.

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